BERING(FORBODING)

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ABSTRACT

Bering(forboding) is an audiovisual piece created from a combination of field recordings and data taken from field footage. Bering(forboding) is an example of using multiple data elements in the composition process, and using data elements as methods of conveying narrative through the creative interaction between composer and data.

The creative process behind this work involves the use of data structures as ways of driving sonification and compositional processes, through collected digital media and computer-assisted composition. The work is also intended to explore how the visual and aural can be used to influence the other within the creative process. For Bering(forboding), the initial field footage and recordings were taken from a night spent at Beringbooding Rock, roughly 360km north-east of Perth.

To create the audio track, values from a histogram showing the red, blue, green and luminance channels of a photograph were converted into sound frequencies, and these frequencies were combined with a series of layered, progressively time-stretched recordings (between 200% - 1600%) of a crow recorded in the same area. Three vocal tracks from the composer were also added to this composition, and the finished audio track was used to drive a musical visualisation where audio frequencies were used as keyframes for the animation movements.

With this practice, the visual and aural are linked through a combination of sonifying digital information taken from digital documentation, and using aural information (via combining field recordings with compositions created from various methods of sonification) to re-create visual information through the use of music visualisations.